

- 86.** The miscreants **DESECRATED** the tomb.
(a) Decorated
(b) Respected
(c) Built
(d) Treat with violent disrespect
- 87.** This variety of guava is **PROLIFIC**.
(a) Bearing Less fruits
(b) Bearing no fruits
(c) Prone to diseases
(d) Producing much fruit
- 88.** The actor got **PEEVISH** on asking personal questions
(a) Irritated (b) Happy
(c) Shy (d) Satisfied
- 89.** Painkillers have a **PERNICIOUS** effect on the organs.
(a) Opposite (b) Harmful
(c) Beneficial (d) Calculated
- 90.** The President of the company was **HECKLED** when he addressed the gathering.
(a) Praised (b) Interrupted
(c) Empowered (d) Approved
- 91.** The birth of a girl is still regarded as an **IMPRECATION**.
(a) Blessing (b) Good Omen
(c) Curse (d) Austerity
- 92.** The birds made a **TRILLING** noise in the morning.
(a) Quavering (b) Peculiar
(c) Pleasant (d) Husky
- 93.** **PANTISOCRACY** is a form of
(a) Government by the Wealthy
(b) Government by a small group of people
(c) Government in which all are equal in social position and responsibility.
(d) Government by the poor
- 94.** Garima looked **SHRIVELLED** after recovering from Malaria.
(a) Weak (b) Shrunk
(c) Glowing (d) Drunken
- 95.** Lava was being **EXTRUDED** from the volcano.
(a) Swallowed (b) Cleaned
(c) Inserted (d) Forced out
- 96.** The stray dog was **PUT DOWN** by the residents.
(a) Domesticated
(b) Set Free
(c) Killed
(d) United
- 97.** 450 students were **CONFERRED** degrees in the event organised by the university.
(a) Granted (b) Agreed
(c) Arranged (d) Established
- 98.** A huge wave **SWAMPED** the canoe.
(a) Flood (b) Striked
(c) Destroy (d) Push
- 99.** Rahul claimed that his friend had been **CONSORTING** with the local mafia.
(a) Agreeing (b) Spending time
(c) Fighting (d) Arguing
- 100.** Sakshi was **BANISHED** to an uninhabited island for 6 months.
(a) Vacate (b) Estimate
(c) Deport (d) Flown
- 101.** Rashi is an **EXPONENT** of free thinking.
(a) Supporter (b) Opposer
(c) Patriot (d) Thinker
- 102.** The truck **JUDDERED** to a halt.
(a) Shook (b) Stopped
(c) Screeched (d) Came
- 103.** This is another example of big companies joining together to **STOMP ON** small businesses.
(a) Help (b) Promote
(c) Discourage (d) Defeat
- 104.** My friend **KICKED THE BUCKET** when he was 49.
(a) Got famous
(b) Married
(c) To die
(d) Start a new company
- 105.** My goal is **CONGRUENT** with my friend's goal.
(a) Opposite (b) Similar
(c) Different (d) Bigger
- 106.** He treats her with such **DEFERENCE**.
(a) Hostility (b) Disrespect
(c) Criticism (d) Respect
- 107.** Amit made a sharp **RIPOSTE**.
(a) Quick and clever remark
(b) Attack
(c) Exit
(d) Alert
- 108.** Overeating often leads to **DYSPEPSIA**.
(a) Weight gain
(b) Fatness
(c) Vomitting
(d) Indigestion
- 109.** The injection provided a temporary **REPRIEVE** from the pain.
(a) Escape (b) Addiction
(c) Submission (d) Increase
- 110.** Tenants petitioned their **RECALCITRANT** landlord to finish repairs to their building.
(a) Hostile
(b) Pleasing
(c) Unwilling to obey
(d) Irritating
- 111.** A **BENIGN** lady was hurt in the accident.
(a) Rude (b) Insolent
(c) Tricky (d) Kind
- 112.** Lately I have been feeling very **HARRIED** at work.
(a) Worried (b) Hurt
(c) Relaxed (d) Guilty
- 113.** We won't have discussions with them until they **ESCHEW** violence.
(a) Give up (b) Take up
(c) Reduce (d) Criminalise
- 114.** His ruthless accumulation of wealth stands as a **PARADIGM** of greed in the business industry.
(a) Supporter (b) Opposer
(c) Model (d) Arbitrator
- 115.** Soldiers from many different countries have been **SUBSUMED** into the UN peace-keeping force.
(a) Excluded (b) Included
(c) Punished (d) Praised
- 116.** The song had a **SOPORIFIC** effect on the child.
(a) Soothing
(b) Terrific
(c) Supreme
(d) Sleep-inducing
- 117.** His **ALLEGIANCE** to the party was suspected from the very beginning.
(a) Servility (b) Obedience
(c) Loyalty (d) Passivity
- 118.** Sympathetic criticism has a **SALUTARY** effect.
(a) Premature (b) Terrible
(c) Disastrous (d) Beneficial
- 119.** His bad behaviour **EVOKED** punishment.
(a) Escaped (b) Called for
(c) Produced (d) Summoned

QUESTIONS FROM **CDS EXAM (2012-2016)**

Directions (Q. Nos. 1-106) Each of the following items consists of a sentence followed by four words or group of words. Select the **synonym** of word (occurring in the sentence in capital letters) as per the context.

2012 (I)

1. I never believed that it was the **AUTHENTIC** signature of the Prime Minister.
(a) Hand-written (b) Genuine
(c) Proper (d) Authoritative
2. Valiant Vicky used to **BOAST** of his bravery to his beloved wife.
(a) Cry (b) Abuse
(c) Hate (d) Brag
3. I can no longer be satisfied with **FICTITIOUS** good conduct.
(a) Based on facts
(b) Based on imagination
(c) Based on works of fiction
(d) Based on feudal ties
4. **MASS MURDER** is very often a result of communal frenzy.
(a) Patricide (b) Fratricide
(c) Regicide (d) Genocide
5. The two **EXECUTIONERS** approached the tree with a red mark on its side.
(a) Executive engineers
(b) Explorers
(c) Experimenters
(d) Those who inflict capital punishment
6. The **MAIDEN SPEECH** of the young member of the Lok Sabha was very much appreciated by the people.
(a) Farewell speech
(b) Short speech
(c) First speech
(d) Speech about women
7. Please do not **INTERFERE** with my work.
(a) Meddle (b) Help
(c) Object (d) Copy
8. This job is very **TEDIOUS**.
(a) Tiresome (b) Dull
(c) Interesting (d) Exciting
9. She **TAKES AFTER** her mother.
(a) Follows (b) Comes after
(c) Resembles (d) Imitates
10. He is very intelligent, but **ILL-FAVoured** by nature.
(a) Unlucky
(b) Weak in health

- (c) Short-tempered
(d) Ugly
11. People thronged to pay **HOMAGE** to the departed leader.
(a) Humility (b) Tribute
(c) Obedience (d) Allegiance
 12. He kept his eyes peeled and his ears pricked for some important **CLUE**.
(a) Hint (b) Inkling
(c) Intimation (d) Signal
 13. The spectators looked at the batsman in **AMAZEMENT** when he hit sixer after sixer.
(a) Shock (b) Wonder
(c) Surprise (d) Suspicion
 14. Very few of our batsmen have any real **CONSISTENCY**.
(a) Constancy (b) Competence
(c) Permanence (d) Uniformity
 15. He has an **ELECTRIFYING** presence.
(a) Attractive (b) Fearsome
(c) Exciting (d) Disturbing
 16. For better health we must **REFRAIN** from smoking.
(a) Dissuade (b) Desist
(c) Prevent (d) Curb
 17. The article was so well written that it **MERITED** careful study.
(a) Deserved (b) Encouraged
(c) Prompted (d) Supported

2012 (II)

18. **PROHIBIT**
(a) Forbid (b) Forfeit
(c) Forsake (d) Forbear
19. **DUBIOUS**
(a) Dismal (b) Doubtful
(c) Derogatory (d) Devilish
20. **ECCENTRIC**
(a) Destructive (b) Deceitful
(c) Conformist (d) Unconventional
21. **CONTRADICT**
(a) Request politely
(b) Deny emphatically
(c) Talk abusively
(d) Contempt

22. **GIVE UP**
(a) Abandon (b) Present
(c) Lift (d) Scatter
23. **SPECIFIC**
(a) Proper (b) Uncommon
(c) Noteworthy (d) Precise
24. **ERADICATE**
(a) Put up (b) Remove
(c) Soften (d) Suppress
25. **PROBABLE**
(a) Certain (b) Indefinite
(c) Likely (d) Temporary
26. **ADHERE**
(a) Act reluctantly
(b) Give allegiance
(c) Waver frequently
(d) React promptly
27. **INFER**
(a) Conclude (b) Calculate
(c) Debate (d) Suggest
28. **HESITATE**
(a) Afraid to talk
(b) Unwilling to act
(c) Unwilling to speak
(d) Unable to decide quickly
29. **EXPLICIT**
(a) Immediate
(b) Plainly stated
(c) Marked
(d) Revealing the secret
30. **SUFFICIENT**
(a) Adequate (b) Complete
(c) Full (d) Frugal
31. **REPRESS**
(a) Express (b) Impress
(c) Curb (d) Confuse
32. **VINDICTIVE**
(a) Cruel (b) Harsh
(c) Revengeful (d) Rude

2013 (II)

33. **PAINSTAKING**
(a) Feeling panic
(b) Thorough and rigorous
(c) Taking risk
(d) Painful and sorrowful

34. SUBSTANTIAL

- (a) Delicate (b) Graceful
(c) Sensational (d) Significant

35. INDOLENT

- (a) Cautious (b) Lazy
(c) Unintelligent (d) Stubborn

36. VEHEMENTLY

- (a) Devoutly (b) Serenely
(c) Hysterically (d) Forcefully

37. OBLIVIOUS

- (a) Narrow-minded (b) Daring
(c) Stubborn (d) Unaware

38. FEIGNED

- (a) Pretended (b) Played
(c) Developed (d) Failed

39. PENURY

- (a) Poverty (b) Petty
(c) Phony (d) Pathetic

40. AFFECTATION

- (a) Adoration (b) Artificiality
(c) Appreciation (d) Proficiency

41. STIFLE

- (a) Starve (b) Stumble
(c) Smother (d) Stagger

42. BESEECH

- (a) Request (b) Overwhelm
(c) Bless (d) Promise

43. STALEMATE

- (a) Degeneration (b) Deadlock
(c) Exhaustion (d) Settlement

44. IMPROMPTU

- (a) Important (b) Impressive
(c) Inspiring (d) Offhand

45. LUCRATIVE

- (a) Profitable (b) Important
(c) Challenging (d) Worthwhile

46. FORTHRIGHT

- (a) Honest and outspoken
(b) Serious and stubborn
(c) Strong and brave
(d) Willing and determined

47. REPRIMAND

- (a) Praise (b) Reminder
(c) Rebuke (d) Reward

48. PUNCTILIOUS

- (a) Serious (b) Careful
(c) Punctual (d) Hardworking

49. DISCREET

- (a) Mature (b) Intelligent
(c) Clever (d) Prudent

50. MOMENTOUS

- (a) Time-tested (b) Momentary
(c) Very important (d) Hectic

51. PORTEND

- (a) Profess (b) Portray
(c) Think (d) Foreshadow

52. ODIUM

- (a) Illness (b) Hatred
(c) Oddity (d) Devious

2014 (I)**53. She is a woman of STERLING qualities.**

- (a) Interesting (b) Genuine
(c) Irritating (d) Exciting

54. Although the boys in his class were naughty, he never resorted to CORPORAL punishment.

- (a) Harsh (b) Physical
(c) Unjust (d) General

55. He wanted to MITIGATE his burdens.

- (a) Lessen (b) Increase
(c) Postpone (d) Leave

56. She adjusted quite well with her husband's IDIOSYNCRASIES.

- (a) Peculiar habits
(b) Bad habits
(c) Weaknesses
(d) Stupid manners

57. The Deputy Inspector General made a PERFUNCTORY inspection of the police station.

- (a) Thorough and complete
(b) Superficial
(c) Done as a routine but without interest
(d) Intensive

58. The decision to drop the atom bomb on Hiroshima was a GRAVE one.

- (a) Serious (b) Momentous
(c) Instinctive (d) Impulsive

59. A scientist generally carries out his investigations EMPIRICALLY.

- (a) By intuitively
(b) By verbally
(c) through written communication
(d) By observation and experiment

60. He is employed in an ORDNANCE factory.

- (a) Orthodox
(b) Arms and ammunition
(c) Electrical and electronic
(d) Ordinary and common

61. He is A SYCOPHANT who tries to win over politicians.

- (a) A psychologist
(b) An opportunist
(c) An unscrupulous man
(d) A flatterer

62. I cannot believe in the VERACITY of his statement.

- (a) Truth (b) Usefulness
(c) Sincerity (d) Falsity

2014 (II)**63. ASPIRE**

- (a) Breathe (b) Stairs
(c) Hope for (d) Thorn

64. SEQUEL

- (a) Ending (b) Beginning
(c) Continuation (d) Similarity

65. PERPETUAL

- (a) Constant (b) Real
(c) Mistaken (d) Painful

66. ASSENT

- (a) Despatch (b) Climb
(c) Flavour (d) Agreement

67. DEFIANCE

- (a) Attack (b) Disobedience
(c) Protection (d) Shyness

68. HOSTILITY

- (a) Kindness (b) Enmity
(c) Entertainment (d) Illness

69. INDIFFERENT

- (a) Similar (b) Various
(c) Unconcerned (d) Shy

70. CONDEMN

- (a) Censure (b) Approve
(c) Qualify (d) Despair

71. CONFIDENT

- (a) Full (b) Friendly
(c) Sure (d) Secret

72. DEFECT

- (a) Truth (b) Deception
(c) Shortcoming (d) Loss

73. JEALOUS

- (a) Envious (b) Happy
(c) Prisoner (d) Enthusiastic

74. TRIP

- (a) Journey (b) Plant
(c) Design (d) Press

2015 (I)**75. DEPLORE**

- (a) Condemn (b) Entreat
(c) Regret (d) Malign

76. MOTIVATION

- (a) Persuade (b) Emotion
(c) Ambition (d) Incitement

77. RESIDUE

- (a) Remainder (b) Nothing
(c) Recede (d) Little

78. PERPETUAL

- (a) Perfect (b) Confused
(c) Never ending (d) Seasonal

79. ASSENT

- (a) Climb (b) Confirm
(c) Answer (d) Agree

80. DEFIANCE

- (a) Insult (b) Denial
(c) Degradation (d) Resistance

81. EMANCIPATE

- (a) Liberate (b) Release
(c) Acquit (d) Unchain

82. HOSTILITY

- (a) Hospitality (b) Jealousy
(c) Enmity (d) Envy

2015 (II)**83. All these items have been MARKED DOWN.**

- (a) Reserved
(b) Packed up
(c) Reduced in price
(d) Entered

84. How can you have the EFFRONTERY to ask for another loan?

- (a) Right (b) Impudence
(c) Heart (d) Courage

85. There was a DEVASTATING attack on his work.

- (a) Terrible (b) Casual
(c) Unethical (d) Motivated

86. The committee conducted an EXHAUSTIVE inquiry.

- (a) Time-consuming
(b) Complicated
(c) Renewed
(d) Thorough

87. He is just LAYING UP a lot of trouble for himself.

- (a) Clearing (b) Accumulating
(c) Accepting (d) Removing

88. He fought the demon with all his MIGHT.

- (a) Heaviness (b) Strength
(c) Density (d) Popularity

89. Devotees believe that God DWELLS in their heart.

- (a) Lives (b) Insists
(c) Travels (d) Enters

90. Not everyone can RESPOND TO a difficult question quickly.

- (a) Discuss (b) Argue
(c) Answer (d) Deny

91. The sage did not want to be bothered with MUNDANE concerns.

- (a) Worldly (b) Meaningless
(c) Trivial (d) Superfluous

92. Mountaineering in bad weather is DANGEROUS.

- (a) Threatening (b) Shaky
(c) Perilous (d) Slippery

93. Stellar groupings tend to be UNLIMITED.

- (a) Lengthy (b) Heavenly
(c) Huge (d) Infinite

94. One who rules with unlimited power is called a DICTATOR.

- (a) Anarchist (b) Autocrat
(c) Egoist (d) Sychophant

95. He was not ready with his ANNUAL accounts.

- (a) Yearly (b) Important
(c) Monthly (d) Permanent

96. Society cannot depend upon a FANATIC for guidance.

- (a) Optimist (b) Martyr
(c) Bigot (d) Anarchist

97. A busy person cannot waste his time on TRIVIAL issues.

- (a) Unimportant (b) Rude
(c) Crude (d) Tribal

2016 (I)**98. AMBIGUOUS**

- (a) Contrasting (b) Connivance
(c) Vague (d) Wilful

99. ELUCIDATE

- (a) Clarify (b) Calculate
(c) Summarise (d) Update

100. MONOTONOUS

- (a) Dreary
(b) Dreadful
(c) Single-minded
(d) Monologue

101. KINDLE

- (a) Make fun of (b) Excite
(c) Very kind (d) Kind-hearted

102. PALATIAL

- (a) Very clean (b) Very special
(c) Sense of taste (d) Magnificent

103. TACTFUL

- (a) Diplomatic (b) Indifferent
(c) Intelligent (d) Deceitful

104. VORACIOUS

- (a) Very bad (b) Insatiable
(c) Stingy (d) Malicious

105. STRICTURE

- (a) Strictness (b) Stinging
(c) Discipline (d) Censure

106. OBEISANCE

- (a) Homage (b) Pilgrimage
(c) Subjugation (d) Obligation

ANSWERS**Check Your Vocabulary**

1	d	2	b	3	a	4	b	5	d	6	a	7	c	8	b	9	d	10	c
11	d	12	c	13	b	14	a	15	c	16	a	17	a	18	b	19	b	20	a
21	c	22	d	23	a	24	c	25	c	26	b	27	a	28	a	29	c	30	b
31	d	32	c	33	b	34	d	35	d	36	b	37	a	38	a	39	d	40	c
41	a	42	d	43	c	44	a	45	a	46	a	47	c	48	d	49	a	50	a
51	d	52	c	53	b	54	a	55	a	56	b	57	a	58	c	59	d	60	c
61	d	62	d	63	a	64	b	65	c	66	d	67	b	68	b	69	c	70	a
71	b	72	a	73	c	74	a	75	b	76	c	77	b	78	a	79	b	80	b
81	b	82	a	83	b	84	b	85	c	86	d	87	d	88	a	89	b	90	b
91	c	92	a	93	c	94	b	95	d	96	c	97	a	98	a	99	b	100	c
101	a	102	a	103	d	104	c	105	b	106	d	107	a	108	d	109	a	110	c
111	d	112	a	113	a	114	c	115	b	116	d	117	c	118	d	119	b		

Questions from CDS Exam (2012-16)

1	b	2	d	3	c	4	d	5	d	6	c	7	a	8	a	9	c	10	d
11	b	12	a	13	a	14	a	15	c	16	b	17	a	18	a	19	b	20	d
21	b	22	a	23	d	24	b	25	c	26	b	27	a	28	d	29	b	30	a
31	c	32	c	33	c	34	d	35	b	36	d	37	d	38	a	39	a	40	b
41	c	42	a	43	b	44	d	45	a	46	a	47	c	48	b	49	d	50	c
51	d	52	b	53	b	54	b	55	a	56	a	57	b	58	a	59	d	60	b
61	d	62	a	63	c	64	c	65	a	66	d	67	b	68	b	69	c	70	a
71	c	72	c	73	a	74	a	75	a	76	a	77	a	78	c	79	d	80	d
81	a	82	c	83	c	84	b	85	a	86	d	87	b	88	b	89	a	90	c
91	a	92	c	93	d	94	b	95	a	96	c	97	a	98	c	99	a	100	a
101	b	102	d	103	a	104	b	105	d	106	a								

 EXPLANATIONS
Check Your Vocabulary

1. (d) Modest means to be free of conceit or pretension. So, 'humble' is its synonym.
2. (b) Custom means long established practice. So, 'habit' is its synonym.
3. (a) Prolong means lengthen in time. So, 'extend' is its synonym.
4. (b) Hustle means to move quickly. So, 'hurry' is its synonym.
5. (d) Solemn means very serious or formal in manner, behaviour or expression. So, 'serious' is its synonym.
6. (a) Imply means express indirectly. So, 'suggest' is its synonym.
7. (c) Ramble means move aimlessly from place to place. So, 'wander' is its synonym.
8. (b) Beneficial means causing benefit. So, 'advantageous' is its synonym.
9. (d) Flare means a fire. So, 'blaze' is its synonym.
10. (c) Negligent means marked by neglect. So, 'careless' is its synonym.
11. (d) Aloof means not friendly. So, 'reserved' is its synonym.
12. (c) One meaning of resolve is to 'decide'.
13. (b) To congregate means 'to gather in a group'.
14. (a) To utter means 'to express in words'.
15. (c) Fearless means 'lacking fear or brave'.
16. (a) Negligible means very small or unimportant. So, 'insignificant' is its synonym.
17. (a) Placid means free of disturbance. So, 'calm' is its synonym.
18. (b) A rake is a dissolute person. So, 'scoundrel' is its synonym.
19. (b) Dupe means deceive. So, 'trick' is its synonym.
20. (a) Stigma means a mark of shame or discredit. So, 'stain' is its synonym.
21. (c) Reside means occupy a place as one's home. So, 'dwell' is its synonym.
22. (d) Covetous means having or showing a great desire to possess something belonging to someone else. So, 'greedy' is its synonym.
23. (a) Abide means accept or bear someone or something bad, unpleasant etc. So, 'endure' is its synonym.
24. (c) Shrewd means having or showing sharp powers of judgement. So, 'astute' is its synonym.
25. (c) Fetter means restrain. So, 'hamper' is its synonym.
26. (b) Flagrant means too bad to be ignored. So, 'glaring' is its synonym.
27. (a) Mitigate means to make less severe or painful. So, 'relieve' is its synonym.
28. (a) Rail means 'scolld in harsh, abusive language'.
29. (c) Meld means merge. So, 'blend' is its synonym.
30. (b) Rally means 'muster for a common purpose'.
31. (d) Abject means extremely bad or severe. So, 'extreme' is its synonym.
32. (c) Bespoke means custom made; 'tailored' also means custom-made.
33. (b) Diffident means shy and lacking in confidence. So, 'shy' is its synonym.
34. (d) Proffer means put something forward for acceptance. So, 'tender' is its synonym.
35. (d) Mordant means cruel and criticising in a humorous way. So, 'caustic' is its synonym.
36. (b) Churlish means impolite. So, 'boorish' is its synonym.
37. (a) Antediluvian means very old or old-fashioned. So, 'antiquated' is its synonym.
38. (a) Picayune means of little value or significance. So, 'petty' is its synonym.
39. (d) Smite means 'to strike heavily especially with a weapon or the hand'.
40. (c) Winnow means 'to get rid of', So, 'weed' is its synonym.
41. (a) Exploit means to make full use of and derive benefit from a resource. So, 'utilise' is its synonym.
42. (d) Detrimental means 'harmful'.
43. (c) One meaning of sharp is 'precisely or exactly'.
44. (a) Condemn means 'to express complete disapproval of or censure'.